The Noble One Called "Pleasing"

Toh 1033 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་ཡིད་དུ་འོང་བ་ཞེས་བྱ།

The Noble One Called "Pleasing," known in Tibetan as Phakpa Yidu Ongwa Zhejawa and concluding under the name The Pleasing Dhāraṇī, is a very brief ritual text built around a short mantra addressed to the uṣṇīṣa, the crown protuberance of a buddha. After an opening homage to the buddhas, it gives the mantra and says it works through recitation alone, without any prior practice. It then describes several simple applications. Reciting the mantra one hundred and eight times over bezoar and marking the forehead makes one pleasing to everyone. Applying an empowered substance to the eyes causes others to look on one with favor. Drinking water over which the mantra has been recited leads others to offer food and hold one dear. A Sanskrit title for the work is not clearly attested, so it is best described simply as a dhāraṇī of attraction and goodwill. It is Toh 1033 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī texts, the collection of short incantations valued for their protective and practical benefits.

The Noble One Called "Pleasing"

Homage to the buddhas, the blessed ones!

namo bhagabate uṣṇīṣāya dhāre dharanatiye svāhā

Even without having accomplished it through practice, it takes effect simply by being recited. If one recites it one hundred and eight times over bezoar and makes a mark with it on one's forehead, one will become pleasing to everyone. If one recites the mantra over tica and applies it to one's eyes, whoever one looks at will meet one's gaze with favor. If one recites the mantra over water and drinks it, others will give one food and hold one dear.

The Pleasing Dhāraṇī is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The title gives only "the noble one called 'Pleasing'". The closing line shows that the work is a dhāraṇī. The substance "ti tsa" applied to the eyes could not be identified with confidence. It is given as "tica"; it is presumably an eye ointment or collyrium. The final syllable "sho" after the colophon is a scribal flourish and has not been rendered.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.